



Webbersaurus

REVIEW ISSUE SUMMARY

Competitor Retaliatory Review on Google Business Profile

Prepared for **Fred's Tree Removal**

March 2, 2026

OVERVIEW

What Happened

Josh Carouso of Shoreline Trees (Clinton, CT) left a 1-star review on your Google Business Profile. Here's a breakdown of the full situation and the steps we're taking to resolve it.

Timeline of Events

Josh Carouso (Shoreline Trees) Posts 1-Star Review

Josh Carouso, owner of competing tree service Shoreline Trees in Clinton, CT, left a 1-star review on your Google Business Profile. This review is still live and visible on your profile today.

Ed Responds with a Retaliatory Review

In response, Ed left a 1-star review on Shoreline Trees' Google Business Profile.

Current Status

Josh Carouso's 1-star review on your profile remains active and is dragging down your overall score. Meanwhile, Ed's review on Shoreline Trees' profile has had its text removed by Google, though the 1-star rating remains on their end.

COMPETITOR CONFLICT OF INTEREST

This Review Violates Google's Policies

Josh Carouso is the owner of a directly competing tree service business. His review on your profile is not a legitimate customer review — it is a conflict of interest. Google's review policies explicitly prohibit reviews from competitors, and this gives us strong grounds to have it removed.

Google Policy Is on Your Side

Google's review policies **explicitly prohibit** reviews that represent a conflict of interest — including reviews left by competitors. We can document that Josh Carouso operates Shoreline Trees, a competing tree service in the same market

area, which strengthens our case for full removal of the review and its rating from your profile.

IMPORTANT RECOMMENDATION

Ed Should Remove His Review on Shoreline Trees

Ed's retaliatory 1-star review on Shoreline Trees' profile has already had its text removed by Google, though the rating remains. We **strongly recommend Ed delete this review entirely**. Here's why: when we file our complaint with Google about Josh Carouso's review on your profile, having a competing review from your business on their profile weakens our position. Removing it demonstrates good faith, makes your case cleaner, and eliminates any risk of Ed's Google account being flagged for the same conflict-of-interest policy violation we're reporting.

ACTION PLAN

Steps We're Taking to Resolve This

Here's what we'll be doing on your behalf to get this corrected.

1

Ed Removes His Review on Shoreline Trees

This is the critical first step. Removing Ed's retaliatory review cleans up your side and puts you in the strongest possible position before we escalate to Google.

2

Flag Josh Carouso's Review in Your GBP Dashboard

We'll flag the review on your profile as a conflict of interest from a direct competitor and provide documentation linking Josh Carouso to Shoreline Trees.

3

Submit a Google Business Redressal Form

This is Google's official process for resolving review policy violations. We'll document the competitor relationship and request full removal of the review and its rating.

4

Contact Google Business Profile Support

If the review isn't removed through flagging and the redressal form, we'll contact GBP support directly and escalate through the community forum where Google Product Experts can take action.

**Questions? We're Here to Help.****Chris Hauman**203.530.7396 | chris@webbersaur.uswebbersaur.us